Austin Lawn Care Calendar

A practical 12-month guide for Central Texas lawns

Use this calendar as a starting point for Bermuda, St. Augustine and Zoysia lawns. Adjust the work to your grass, shade, soil, rainfall and current conditions.

Before you start: This is general guidance, not a fixed treatment schedule. Watering rules change and differ by provider. Check your current local restrictions before watering; new sod may need an approved variance. Follow product labels and ask a qualified professional when needed.

Good habits all year

- Mow according to growth and avoid removing more than one-third of the leaf height at once.
- Water only when needed and allowed; skip irrigation when rain has supplied enough moisture.
- Do not fertilize dormant or drought-stressed warm-season grass. Consider a soil test to guide nutrient decisions.

Winter to early spring

JANUARY | Observe and plan

- Clear heavy leaf buildup and debris when the ground is not saturated or frozen.
- Dormant warm-season grass can turn brown in winter; avoid pushing growth with fertilizer.
- Check tools, sharpen mower blades and note areas with drainage or weed concerns.

FEBRUARY | Prepare, do not rush

- Identify your grass type and consider a soil test before planning fertilizer.
- If crabgrass has been a problem, ask about pre-emergent timing before it germinates. Choose only a product labeled for your grass and follow its directions.
- Water only when needed and permitted by current local rules.

MARCH | Watch for green-up

- Mow as the lawn starts growing; adjust frequency rather than cutting too short.
- Check sprinklers for leaks, overspray and runoff when testing is permitted.
- Wait until warm-season grass is actively growing and has been mowed at least twice before considering spring nitrogen.

Spring to early summer

APRIL | Support active growth

- Use soil-test guidance and grass condition to decide whether fertilizer is needed; avoid applying before heavy rain.
- Keep mower blades sharp and follow the one-third rule as growth increases.
- Check your provider's watering schedule and adjust irrigation for rainfall.

MAY | Build healthy habits

- Mow on the schedule your lawn's growth actually requires.
- For compacted soil, consider core aeration while warm-season grass is actively growing and conditions allow recovery. Avoid aerating stressed or newly established turf.
- Watch for runoff or puddling and adjust irrigation without exceeding local restrictions.

JUNE | Prepare for heat

- Check moisture and recent rainfall before watering, and stay within local rules.
- Watch for wilting, footprints that remain in the grass or spreading brown patches; the cause may need investigation.
- Avoid fertilizing grass that is dormant or stressed by heat and drought.

Summer to early fall

JULY | Manage heat stress

- Let mowing frequency follow growth; do not scalp the lawn during hot, dry weather.
- Water only when needed and permitted by your water provider. Avoid runoff onto pavement.
- Investigate persistent damage before choosing a treatment; brown grass can have several causes.

AUGUST | Protect the lawn

- Continue mowing carefully and avoid fertilizer on drought-stressed or dormant turf.
- If winter weeds have been a recurring problem, ask about fall pre-emergent timing and products labeled for your grass.
- Check irrigation equipment and follow any updated watering restrictions.

SEPTEMBER | Plan for cooler weather

- Remove heavy leaf buildup and adjust mowing as growth changes.
- If considering late-season nitrogen, apply only while the grass is actively growing; consult local extension guidance and allow at least six weeks before the expected first frost.
- Choose weed-control products carefully for your grass and follow all label directions.

Fall to winter

OCTOBER | Ease into fall

- Keep leaves from forming a thick, wet mat over the grass.
- Mow only as growth requires and reduce irrigation as weather and rainfall change.
- Avoid pushing late growth as warm-season turf approaches dormancy.

NOVEMBER | Prepare for cold

- Clear accumulated leaves and debris, especially after wet weather.
- Review irrigation settings and local freeze-protection advice; follow the current rules for your provider.
- Do not fertilize dormant warm-season turf.

DECEMBER | Rest and review

- Keep heavy traffic and equipment off frozen or saturated grass where practical.
- Clean tools and make a list of repairs, drainage issues and lawn goals for next year.
- Check current watering restrictions if dry conditions make watering necessary.

Resources and current guidance

- Austin Water: current watering days and restrictions
- Texas A&M AgriLife: Bermudagrass home lawn management calendar
- Texas A&M AgriLife: maintaining St. Augustinegrass lawns
- Texas A&M AgriLife: Zoysiagrass lawn management guide
- Texas A&M AgriLife: fertilizing warm-season lawns
- Texas A&M: soil, water and forage testing laboratory

Check your own water provider for the rules that apply to your property.